A dollar valuation at late stage is a funding structure, not a verdict on the technology.

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Early on, the company sets the price and capital follows. Late, the capital sets the price and the company grows into it, or doesn't.

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A fund that must deploy a very large sum can't buy 2% of a small company. It needs a company priced so its check fits.

Better than "is it justified by revenue multiples?": what kind of capital is this price built to absorb?

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Before the pitch, I check who led, whether the strategic name was essential, the liquidation stack, the exit without the same buyers, and the fees and carry.

> **A private mark is set by buyers inside the round. A public mark is set by a larger, less forgiving crowd. None of this needs a view on the technology. It needs reading the paper.**

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Korea · Gulf · SEA · Central Asia